

PART 2 OF 4

Ten shops, same phones. same street. Nobody wins.

Why competition kills profit, and what makes a business hard to copy.

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swipe →



Competition kills profit

- When ten businesses sell the same thing, they cut prices until nobody makes real money.
- A business with no close substitute keeps its margins and can plan for years, not weeks.



Be honest about your market

- Copycats describe their market so narrowly they look unique: "the only Ghanaian restaurant in Lekki".
- Ask the real question: what else could your customer buy instead?



What makes a business hard to copy

- Technology that's **10× better**, not 10% better
- **Network effects:** it gets better as more people use it
- **Economies of scale:** it gets cheaper as it grows
- A **brand** people trust

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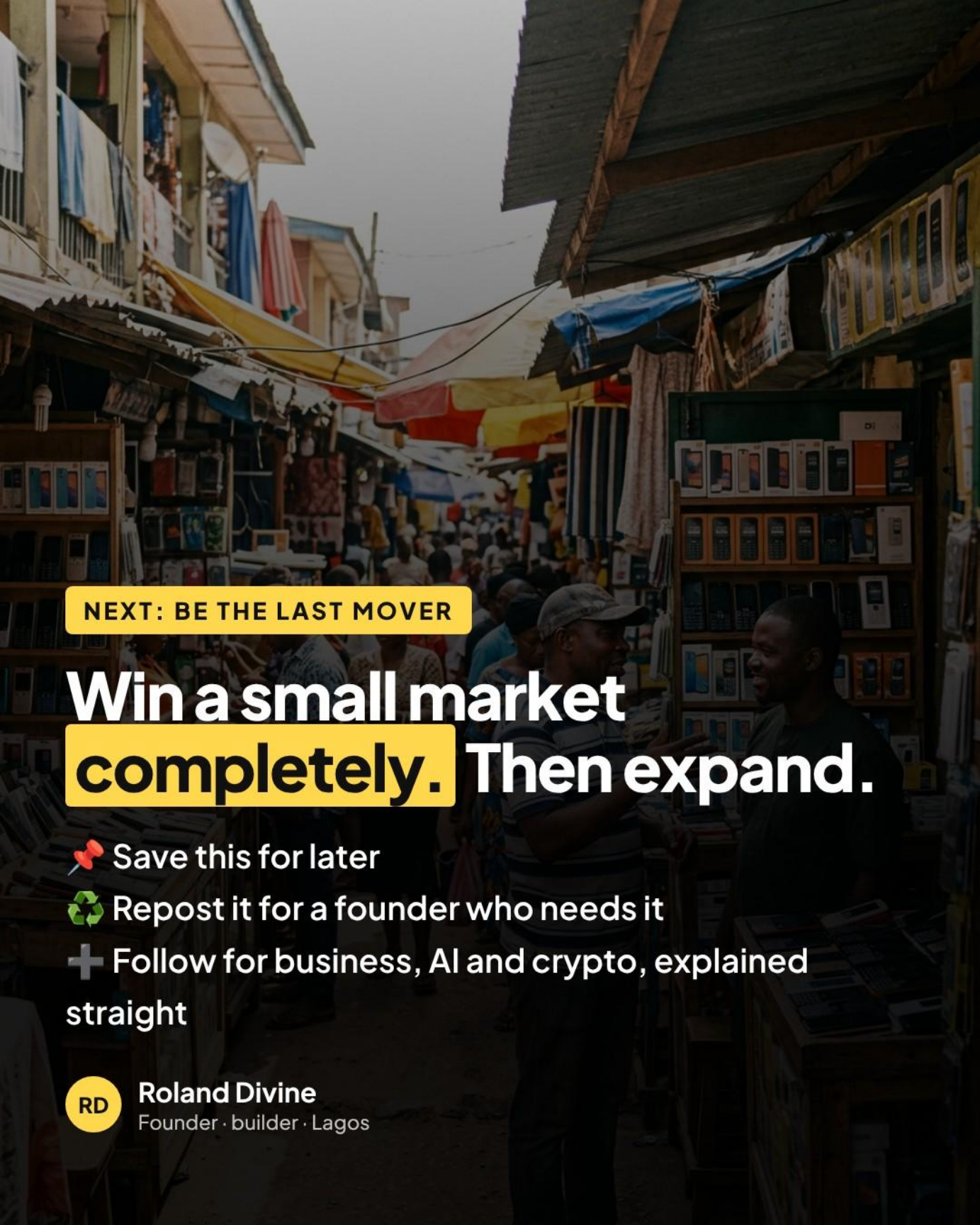
Start small, then dominate

- Amazon started with books. Facebook started at one university. PayPal started with eBay's power sellers.
- Win a small market completely, then expand step by step.



Don't chase "disruption"

- Picking a fight with giants makes you their target.
- And rivalry makes you copy your rival instead of building something new.


NEXT: BE THE LAST MOVER
Win a small market completely. Then expand.
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